

Death, According to the Apostle Paul

Today, we are going to look at several places where Paul gives us some incredible details about what happens to the saints in between death and the resurrection. A state that is repeatedly called in scripture in both the Old and New Testaments by both Christ and the Apostles, "Sleep." In this rare instance, for clarity's sake, I will be using the NLT, but you are welcome to look up each of these passages within the KJV or any Bible translation you prefer.

1 Corinthians 15:42-44 NLT It is the same way with the resurrection of the dead. Our earthly bodies are planted in the ground when we die, but they will be raised to live forever. 43 Our bodies are buried in brokenness, but they will be raised in glory. They are buried in weakness, but they will be raised in strength. 44 They are buried as natural human bodies, but they will be raised as spiritual bodies. For just as there are natural bodies, there are also spiritual bodies.

MORTAL HUMAN BODIES	IMMORTAL ANGEL BODIES
Our earthly bodies are planted in the ground when we die	They will be raised to live forever
Our bodies are buried in brokenness	They will be raised in glory
They are buried in weakness	They will be raised in strength
They are buried as natural human bodies	They will be raised as spiritual bodies
There are natural bodies	There are also spiritual bodies

1 Corinthians 15:50-57 NLT What I am saying, dear brothers and sisters, is that our physical bodies cannot inherit the Kingdom of God. These dying bodies cannot inherit what will last forever. 51 But let me reveal to you a wonderful secret. We will not all die, but we will all be transformed! 52 It will happen in a moment, in the blink of an eye, when the last trumpet is blown. we will all be transformed. And we who are living will also be transformed. 53 For our dying bodies must be transformed into bodies that will never die; our mortal bodies must be transformed into immortal bodies. 54 Then, when our dying bodies have been transformed into bodies that will never die, this Scripture will be fulfilled: “Death is swallowed up in victory. 55 O death, where is your victory? O death, where is your sting?” 56 For sin is the sting that results in death, and the law gives sin its power. 57 But thank God! He gives us victory over sin and death through our Lord Jesus Christ.

MORTAL HUMAN BODIES	IMMORTAL ANGEL BODIES
Our physical bodies cannot inherit the Kingdom of God	We will not all die, but we will all be transformed
These dying bodies cannot inherit what will last forever	It will happen in a moment, in the blink of an eye, when the last trumpet is blown. we will all be transformed
For our dying bodies must be transformed	We who are living will also be transformed
When our dying bodies have been transformed	Into immortal bodies

2 Corinthians 5:1-10 NLT For we know that when this earthly tent we live in is taken down (that is, when we die and leave this earthly body), we will have a house in heaven, an eternal body made for us by God himself and not by human hands. 2 We grow weary in our present bodies, and we long to put on our heavenly bodies like new clothing. 3 For we will put on heavenly bodies; we will not be spirits without bodies. 4 While we live in these earthly bodies, we groan and sigh, but it's not that we want to die and get rid of these bodies that clothe us. Rather, we want to put on our new bodies so that these dying bodies will be swallowed up by life. 5 God himself has prepared us for this, and as a guarantee he has given us his Holy Spirit. 6 So we are always confident, even though we know that as long as we live in these bodies we are not at home with the Lord. 7 For we live by believing and not by seeing. 8 Yes, we are fully confident, and we would rather be away from these earthly bodies, for then we will be at home with the Lord. 9 So whether we are here in this body or away from this body, our goal is to please him. 10 For we must all stand before Christ to be judged. We will each receive whatever we deserve for the good or evil we have done in this earthly body.

MORTAL HUMAN BODIES	IMMORTAL ANGEL BODIES
When this earthly tent we live in is taken down (that is, when we die and leave this earthly body)	We will have a house in heaven, an eternal body made for us by God himself and not by human hands.
We grow weary in our present bodies	We long to put on our heavenly bodies like new clothing
These dying bodies will be swallowed up by life	We want to put on our new bodies

As long as we live in these bodies we are not at home with the Lord	We would rather be away from these earthly bodies, for then we will be at home with the Lord
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“We will not be spirits without bodies” 2 Corinthians 5:3

Disembodied: separated from or existing without the body.: "a disembodied ghost".

1 Thessalonians 4:13-18 NLT And now, dear brothers and sisters, we want you to know what will happen to the believers who have died so you will not grieve like people who have no hope.

14 For since we believe that Jesus died and was raised to life again, we also believe that when Jesus returns, God will bring back with him the believers who have died. 15 We tell you this directly from the Lord: We who are still living when the Lord returns will not meet him ahead of those who have died. 16 For the Lord himself will come down from heaven with a commanding shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trumpet call of God. First, the believers who have died will rise from their graves. 17 Then, together with them, we who are still alive and remain on the earth will be caught up in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. Then we will be with the Lord forever. 18 So encourage each other with these words.

1. For the Lord himself will come down from heaven with a commanding shout, with the voice of the archangel, and with the trumpet call of God. 1 Thessalonians 4:16

2. First, the believers who have died will rise from their graves. 1 Thessalonians 4:16

3. Then, together with them, we who are still alive and remain on the earth will be caught up in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air 1 Thessalonians 4:17

a. We who are still living when the Lord returns will not meet him ahead of those who have died 1 Thessalonians 4:15

b. God will bring back with him the believers who have died 1 Thessalonians 4:14

1 Thessalonians 4:14 are not disembodied spirits/ghosts of dead saints. **“We will not be spirits**

without bodies” 2 Corinthians 5:3 (NLT).. Rather, 1 Thessalonians 4:14 are the resurrected dead, and those remaining alive who are translated and then raised to meet the Lord in the air together in v. 17.

According to the Apostle Paul, there are two bodies: one mortal, flesh and blood, that dies, and, secondly, a heavenly, immortal angel-like body now in heaven. Those who die do not exist as disembodied spirits/ghosts in limbo, in between inhabiting these two bodies. Rather, that in-between state is called “sleep.” Individuals who die are unaware of any time that elapses. This in-between sleep state seems to last no more than a twinkling of an eye to those who have died. At the last trump, the dead are raised from the grave, changed into their new angel-like bodies, as if they had changed clothes.